sub-imperial outpost during the Cold War, what with liberation struggles raging in surrounding countries during the 1960s–1980s. Extra-economic coercion in support of raw material extraction is a common feature of this power, when in many cases the role of regional 'deputy sheriff' is not just 'peace-keeping' but transferring surpluses from the hinterland to the sub-imperialist capital city, and often from there to the imperialist headquarters, as is especially evident for contemporary South Africa (Bond 2006a, 2006b).

The second is advancing the broader agenda of globalised neoliberalism, so as to legitimate deepened market access. This occurs insofar as most sub-imperial powers have been enthusiastic financial backers of the main institutions of global economic governance, especially the Bretton Woods Institutions and World Trade Organisation. For rhetorical purposes the sub-imperial powers' foreign, trade and even finance ministries may be less than flattering about global governance and, in the case of the BRICS, may even launch new multilateral initiatives with the stated aim of challenging power. But standing by the IMF even in times of crisis – e.g. the institution's recapitalisation in 2009 and 2012 occurred with notable BRICS support (US$75 billion in coordinated aid in the latter case) – reflects the overall role that sub-imperial regimes play: they lubricate, legitimise and extend neoliberal political economy deeper into their regional hinterlands.

The same has been true in the single most important long-term global governance challenge, climate management, where the BRICS (without Russia) lined up as critical allies within Washington's 'Copenhagen Accord' strategy in 2009, both avoiding emissions cuts and promoting the further financialisation of the climate strategy through extended carbon trading (Bond 2012; Böhm, Misoczky and Moog 2012). (Later, Russia cemented this function by raising its own greenhouse gas emissions and fossil fuel extraction dramatically and then reneging on Kyoto Protocol commitments and withdrawing from the main climate treaty.) This role of propping up global economic and environmental malgovernance often benefits home-based corporations in the sub-imperial countries, but it is also a marker of cooperation and collaboration with the imperialist projects of core countries' multinational corporations and states: extension of the neoliberal conception that everything can and should be commodified, *even the air* through carbon markets.

Another example of where this was not only helpful but necessary was the World Trade Organisation (WTO), which in an earlier manifestation several BRICS countries had sought to revitalise as early as the 2005 Hong Kong ministerial summit. Free-trade corporate expansion and ongoing self-interested protectionism prevail in an often uneasy mix in sub-imperial economies. But